

Agnese Lombardi

Piazza Della Vittoria, 35 • Pavia (PV) 27100 • +39 333 9188047
agnese.lombardi@iusspavia.it • agneselombardi.github.io • github.com/agneselombardi

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Computational psycho/neurolinguistics: LLMs, agents, interpretability and explainability, mechanistic interpretability, grounding, Bayesian neural networks.

Linguistics: pragmatics and experimental pragmatics, semantics–pragmatics interface, semantics–morphosyntax interface, lexical semantics, Theory of Mind, conversational implicatures, metaphor.

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

PostDoc Researcher — IUSS Pavia, NEPLAB

2026 – present

PI: Valentina Bambini

EDUCATION

PhD in Computational Linguistics — University of Pisa, CoLing Lab

2022 – 2025

Thesis: “Do Machines have a (Theory of) Mind? An investigation across Large Language Models and Humans.”

Supervisors: Alessandro Lenci, Domenica Romagno

Master's Degree in Linguistics and Translation — University of Pisa

2019 – 2021

Curriculum: Theoretical and Applied Linguistics • Supervisor: Alessandro Lenci

Bachelor's Degree in Humanities — University of Pisa

2015 – 2018

Supervisor: Domenica Romagno

Teaching Qualification for Italian High School (Pf-24) — University of Pisa

2020

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles & Conference Proceedings

- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. What Do You Mean? Exploring the Alleged Theory of Mind Abilities of Large Language Models. Under submission. [2026]
- Cameron Jones, **Agnese Lombardi**, Kyle Mahowald, Benjamin Bergen. LLMs and people both learn to form conventions — just not with each other. Accepted. [2026]
- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. ToM Is Not ToM, but a Pragmatic Effect. In Proceedings of CMCL 2026, Palma de Maiorca. [2026]
- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. Conversational Implicatures Through the Lens of LLMs. In Proceeding of LREC 2026, Palma de Maiorca. [2026]
- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. Doing Things with Words: Rethinking Theory of Mind Simulation in Large Language Models. In Proceedings of CLiC-it 2025, Cagliari. [2025]
- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. Agentività e felicità in GiLBERTo: Implicazioni cognitive. In Proceedings of CLiC-it 2021, Milan. [2021]

Edited Volumes

- Francesco Rovai, Marco Sabbatini, **Agnese Lombardi**, Andrea Lupi (eds.). Fenomenologie della memoria: studi letterari, linguistici e filologici a confronto. Pisa University Press, 2026.

PRESENTATIONS

Oral Presentations — as presenter

- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. Conversational Implicatures Through the Lens of LLMs. LREC 2026, Palma de Mallorca, May 2026.
- **Agnese Lombardi**, Chiara Battaglini, Paolo Canal and Valentina Bambini. Do Large Language Models Predict When the Brain Expects a Metaphor? Psycholinguistics in Flanders 2026, Pavia, May 2026.
- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. Evaluating Conversational Implicatures in Large Language Models: Pragmatics or Theory of Mind? LSA Annual Meeting, New Orleans, January 2026.
- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. Doing Things with Words: Rethinking Theory of Mind Simulation in Large Language Models. CLiC-it 2025, Cagliari.

- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. Large Language Models and Theory of Mind: An Analysis with Indirect Speech Acts. Th-XPRAG – IGG49 Pre-conference Workshop, February 2024.
- **Agnese Lombardi**. Large Language Models and Theory of Mind: Testing through Conversational Implicatures. Formae Mentis, Pisa, November 2023.

Oral Presentations — as co-author

- Serena Auriemma, Alessandro Bondielli, Luca Capone, **Agnese Lombardi**, Martina Miliani, Mattia Proietti and Alessandro Lenci. What We Think When We Think About Model Thinking. Workshop on Large Language Models for Linguistics, SLE Annual Meeting, Osnabrück, August 2026.

Posters — as presenter

- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. ToM Is Not ToM, but a Pragmatic Effect. CMCL 2026, Palma de Mallorca, May 2026.
- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. Evaluating Conversational Implicatures in Large Language Models. XPrag 2025, Cambridge.
- **Agnese Lombardi** and Alessandro Lenci. Agentività e felicità in GiLBERTO: Implicazioni cognitive. CLiC-it 2021, Milan.

Posters — as co-author

- Ginevra Martinelli, Biagio Scalingi, Carola Cappadonna, **Agnese Lombardi**, Federico Frau, Cristiano Nichini, Matteo Rocchetti, Cecilia Spallarossa, Marta Bosia, Chiara Barattieri di San Pietro and Valentina Bambini. Speech markers and subjective experience of delusion. Discourse in Psychosis 2026, Pavia.

VISITING POSITIONS & RESEARCH ABROAD

Visiting Scholar — University of Texas at Austin

Advisor: Kyle Mahowald

Oct 2024 – May 2025

AWARDS & FUNDING

Erasmus Fellowship

2024

Scholarship "DSU Toscana"

2015 – 2021

TRAINING & SUMMER SCHOOLS

AI Safety Fundamentals: Alignment Course — BlueDot Impact

Jun – Sep 2024

ESSLLI 2024 — KU Leuven

Jul – Aug 2024

35th European Summer School in Logic, Language and Information

Lectures on Computational Linguistics — University of Bari

Jun 2024

ESSLLI 2023 — University of Ljubljana

Jul – Aug 2023

34th European Summer School in Logic, Language and Information

ESSAI & ACAI 2023 — University of Ljubljana

Jul 2023

1st European Summer School on AI • 20th Advanced Course on AI

Lectures on Computational Linguistics — University of Pisa

May 2023

Curricular Internship, CoLing Lab — University of Pisa

2020

Neural language models (Transformers) • Statistical analysis with R

TEACHING

Student Tutor — University of Pisa

2022 – 2026

Academic years: 2022/23, 2023/24, 2024/25, 2025/26

ORGANISATION OF SCIENTIFIC EVENTS

Battle of Brains: AI — opportunity or risk for education? — University of Pisa

Nov 2024

Fenomenologie della memoria — University of Pisa

Jul 2024

Formae Mentis — University of Pisa

Nov 2023

Processi di scrittura e riscrittura — University of Pisa

Jun 2023

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Peer Review

INPRA 10th (2024) • CLiC-it (2024, 2025) • CMCL (2024, 2026) • LREC (2026) • CogSci (2026) • Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (SNAP, from 2026) • Xprag-IT (2026)

PhD Representative — University of Pisa

2023 – 2025

Volunteer — Discourse in Psychosis 2026

2026

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Intern — Accenture Technology Solutions S.r.l.

Mar – Oct 2022

Mobile Studio department • iOS development: Scuderia Ferrari app (Swift/SwiftUI)

SKILLS

Languages

Italian (native) • English (proficient) • French (intermediate)

Programming

Python (intermediate) • R (intermediate) • SwiftUI (intermediate) • Java (beginner) • Dart/Flutter (beginner) • Git (beginner)

Libraries & Tools

Pandas, NumPy, Hugging Face Transformers, PyTorch • Prolific (psycholinguistic experiments)